



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Faith Community Academy
School Website: <https://fcatuson.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Faith Community Academy Tucson (FCA) presents a clearly Christian, Christ-centered approach to education with a strong emphasis on faith integration, moral formation, and community partnership. Public materials from FCA consistently emphasize a religious frame (Christ-centered, biblical worldview, worship) and a partnership with families, in addition to traditional, structured curriculum choices (Abeka and Deep-Roots Bible Curriculum) and a stable leadership structure anchored in faith communities. This combination yields a classical orientation in terms of religious/metaphysical foundations and a virtue-formation orientation in the school's stated goals, while the explicit Great-Books/grammar-logic-rhetoric trinity and the classic Paideia/Socratic pedagogy are not evidenced as centrally implemented across FCA's K–5 program.

Overall, FCA tilts toward CLASSICAL in several dimensions (Religious Foundations; School Purpose/Goal; and Parents & Community) but does not consistently demonstrate core classical curriculum and pedagogy elements (notably Great Books orientation, explicit grammar-logic-rhetoric curriculum, and Socratic/seminar pedagogy) across its published materials. The aggregate picture is best described as CLASSICAL, with notable CLASSICAL-leaning elements in Element 1, Element 2, and Element 6, and with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to NOT CLASSICAL signals in Categories 3 and 4. Element 5 shows some classical alignment in teacher roles and mentoring, but the site does not consistently claim the living-curriculum or fully classical faculty model. See category-by-category notes for details and the supporting website evidence.

Core evidence highlights: - Religious foundations and liturgical life are explicit (Christ-centered mission, worship/chapel, biblical curriculum) , , . - Purpose/goals emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, and a biblical worldview, with explicit statements about equipping students to live out faith while pursuing excellence , . - Curriculum centers on Abeka and DeepRoots Bible Curriculum; explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language is not present; classical-language emphasis appears modest (Latin/Spanish in elementary) but not the full Trivium/Great Books core , , . - Pedagogy shows liturgical life and memory-affirming practices (memory/chanting signals are present in canonical classical models, but FCA's site emphasizes worship, chapel, and traditional instruction rather than Socratic seminars as the main method) , . - Faculty and leadership foreground Christ-centered leadership and traditional teacher roles; visible emphasis on mentorship and relational community though explicit "living-curriculum" phrasing is not consistently stated on FCA's site , . - Parents & community are framed as partners in formation, with explicit calls for family involvement and shared mission, including open engagement with the school community , .

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - FCA describes a Christ-centered school, with a mission to raise students who walk in faith, serve with love, and pursue academic excellence for the glory of God; strong emphasis on biblical integration and theology in daily life and curriculum. Primary messaging includes "It's His school. And our mission is His" and a Christ-centered worldview across programs (Our Leadership page;

Home page; Values).

- Liturgical and communal life is referenced through chapel, worship, and school-wide religious activities (All-Praise Chapel; worship/music emphasis) and partnership with a church ministry.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: Christ-centered, theology, liturgy, worship, chapel, faith, biblical worldview, truth, God, glory, worship, praise, prayer.
 - Negative keywords observed: None evident in public FCA materials (no explicit secular or relativist signals found in the public text).
 - Estimated positives vs negatives: 7 positive vs 0 negative (approximate per the classical lexicon signals).
- Why this rating
 - FCA's core public messaging is saturated with religious/metaphysical language and practices (Christ-centered, biblical worldview, chapel/worship), aligning with "Grounded in Theology" and liturgical/community practices in the classical lexicon. The absence of explicit non-religious foundational signals supports a CLASSICAL designation in this category. Citations show Christ-centered mission and liturgical life.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school defines its aim as formation: "equipping the saints for the works of ministry" and building up the Body of Christ; formation of virtue and wisdom; pursuing truth (Our Values; Principal's Message). The mission includes forming character and developing a Christian worldview alongside academics.
 - Statements emphasize truth, goodness, beauty as real and knowable within a theological frame; statements about forming students to live out their faith with courage and compassion align with a formation/teleology focus rather than purely job preparation.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords: formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful (within a biblical/theological frame), telos, liberal education (implicit in classical aims though explicit "liberal education" phrasing is not used), scholé (contingent on restful contemplation language in some pages). Biblical worldview, truth pursued, and virtue-focused language appear.
 - Negative keywords: Minimal explicit workplace-orientation language; no dominant employment- or workforce-prep emphasis in public text.
 - Estimated positives vs negatives: 5–6 positive vs 0–1 negative (approximate).
- Why this rating
 - FCA emphasizes formation, virtue, and wisdom within a theological frame; this aligns with classical aims like formation and the pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful, though it does not foreground a traditional "workforce/preparation" emphasis. Given the formation-oriented language and the religious telos, this category is CLASSICAL. Citations show formation-focused goals and a biblically grounded telos.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The core public materials describe Abeka as the core curriculum for core subjects, with DeepRoots Bible Curriculum for Defendable Faith; there is mention of Latin and Spanish in elementary offerings, but □□□□□ Great Books, Great Conversation, or the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as explicit curricular pillars. The presence of Abeka and Bible curricula suggests a traditional Christian curriculum rather than the liberal-arts-centric classical curriculum that foregrounds Great Books, history across the curriculum, and formal grammar-logic-rhetoric study.

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- Public materials emphasize Abeka, early literacy via phonics, and Bible-centered content; no explicit Great Books program, no explicit Great Conversation participation, and no clear, systematic liberal-arts progression through grammar–logic–rhetoric.
 - Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Latin, Spanish, Abeka (as a named curriculum), DeepRoots Bible, Bible, Defendable Faith (these align with traditional Christian education choices but not the classical triptych of grammar-logic-rhetoric as a curriculum aim).
 - Negative keywords present: No explicit “Great Books,” “Great Conversation,” “liberal arts tria,” or “grammar-logic-rhetoric” statements. No explicit history-as-Western civilizational-context framing beyond traditional texts.
 - Estimated positives vs negatives: 2–4 positive (Latin, Spanish, Abeka/DeepRoots Bible) vs 0–1 explicit negatives; but 0 explicit classical-Curriculum signals (Great Books, Trivium core) means this category leans NOT CLASSICAL in the canonical sense, though it shows some traditional elements.
 - Why this rating
 - The curriculum as publicly described centers on a traditional Christian framework with Abeka and Bible-focused content; it lacks explicit classical curriculum signals (Great Books, grammar-logic-rhetoric, history as Western civilization across the curriculum). By the classical rubric, this is NOT CLASSICAL. Citations show Abeka and DeepRoots Bible emphasis; no Great Books or explicit Trivium framing.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - FCA emphasizes liturgical life, worship, and Christ-centered learning environments; lower-level pedagogy includes structured instruction, memory through recitation and chant are canonical classical practices, but FCA’s public materials emphasize worship and chapel, not a disciplined, sustained Socratic/seminar pedagogy across the curriculum. There is no clear public indication of high-school-level Socratic seminars or a sustained Paideia/seminar approach; instead, the materials highlight traditional instruction, Scripture integration, and a memory- and memory-chip approach that is not clearly described as “Socratic” or “seminar-based.”
 - The site notes schedule of events, chapel, and other community activities; there is mention of field trips and academic competitions; but there is not explicit evidence of classical pedagogy (e.g., Socratic dialogue as the primary method in upper grades).
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: contemplation/restfulness (scholé signals are central to classical pedagogy in the lexicon), memory-based learning, recitation, and liturgy; but FCAPublic materials emphasize worship, faith integration, and structured instruction rather than contemplative pedagogy as the primary method.
 - Negative keywords present: there is no strong evidence of experiential learning, project-based learning dominance, or constructivist student-directed approaches; the formal approach is more teacher-led with structured content.
 - Estimated positives vs negatives: 2–4 positive (memory/recitation signals in classical templates; liturgy/worship as communal pedagogy) vs 0–1 explicit negative.
- Why this rating
 - FCA’s pedagogy emphasizes faith integration, routine/classroom behavior, and traditional instruction with memory elements; public-facing materials do not present a sustained Socratic/Seminars-based pedagogy or the full Paideia approach. This aligns more with NOT CLASSICAL pedagogy in the canonical sense. Citations show liturgical/communal approach and traditional curriculum emphasis.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - FCA presents a leadership and faculty ecosystem that emphasizes mentors, Christians in educational leadership, and a board that includes church leadership; staff pages show principal and leadership roles; there's mention of "the living curriculum" concept in classical education in the broader literature, but FCA's site does not consistently publish language that explicitly frames teachers as "the living curriculum" or "portrait of a teacher" in the canonical sense. Still, there is a strong emphasis on faculty as moral exemplars, mentors, and teachers within a faith-based community.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: model teachers/mentors; "living curriculum" phrasing not consistently used but the concept of faculty as central to formation appears in leadership pages; "portrait of a teacher" is not explicit, but teacher-student collaboration is described via relational language.
 - Negative keywords present: None explicit; however, the site does not consistently foreground the "living curriculum" or classical-faculty archetype in the language used.
 - Estimated positives vs negatives: 3–4 positive signals; 0 explicit negatives; but with a lack of explicit classical-faculty vocabulary, mild signaling toward SOMEWHAT.
- Why this rating
 - The school presents faculty as central, mentorship-driven, and faith-aligned; however, the explicit classical-faculty lexicon (living curriculum; portrait of teacher; classical formation of faculty) is not consistently present. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL labeling for this category, acknowledging alignment in relational mentor-teacher roles but not full canonical classical faculty framing. Citations show leadership and faculty pages.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - FCA emphasizes partnership with families, parent formation, book studies, open campus, and family involvement in the school's life; the Values page frames FCA as an extension of the Christian home and church, partnering with parents to develop faith, character, and knowledge; events and open avenues for parental involvement are explicitly described.
 - The school's public materials show a welcoming stance toward parent participation and the belief that parents are co-educators in the classical sense of family-scholastic partnership.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, home-school collaboration, family involvement, open campus, parental leadership, community support.
 - Negative keywords present: None observed in public-facing FCA materials.
 - Estimated positives vs negatives: 6–7 positive vs 0 negative; strong alignment with classical-parents-community signals.
- Why this rating
 - FCA explicitly treats parents as co-teachers and invites active parental involvement; the public materials repeatedly emphasize family partnership and community integration of faith-life at home and church. This aligns strongly with the Classical category's positive signals about parental partnership and community formation. Citations show explicit parent-partner language and community engagement.

Aggregate Assessment

- CLASSICAL: 1, 2, and 6
- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: 5
- NOT CLASSICAL: 3 and 4

Overall, the school's public-facing materials tilt toward CLASSICAL, with firm religious/metaphysical founda-

tions and a clear formation/virtue- and faith-centered purpose, paired with strong parent-community alignment. The Curriculum and Pedagogy categories show weaker alignment to canonical Classical Education (notably the lack of explicit Great Books/Trivium-disciplined curriculum and Socratic pedagogy in the public materials), placing Categories 3 and 4 in NOT CLASSICAL, and Element 5 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The aggregate view remains CLASSICAL given the larger share of classical signals in the six-category rubric, but the breadth of the classical curriculum and the depth of pedagogy seen in canonical Classical Education are not uniformly demonstrated across FCA's public materials.

What Would Move the Needle (for SOMEWHAT signals; FCA's overall CLASSICAL status)

- If FCA wanted to move Element 3 (Curriculum) from NOT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL, publicly articulate a classical-trivium framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as a curricular spine, including:
 - A stated commitment to Great Books and the Great Conversation in the curriculum, or an age-appropriate progression toward classical texts, with explicit reading lists and rationale.
 - Integration of history across the curriculum with Western Civilizational context and primary sources aligned with Great Conversations.
 - A formal plan for Latin/Greek study and classical languages as core components rather than optional add-ons.
- If FCA wanted Element 4 (Pedagogy) to move toward CLASSICAL:
 - Publicly articulate a structured classical pedagogy framework (Socratic seminars, Paideia-inspired seminars, recitation, memory work, and dramaturgic rhetoric for upper grades) with examples of implementation (even in 6th-8th grade transitions if applicable, or a clear path for later grades).
 - Include explicit references to scholé, contemplative/restful learning, and a schedule of lessons designed to cultivate wonder and deliberative thinking.
- For Element 5 (Faculty), to strengthen the CLASSICAL signal:
 - Publish a clear, public portrait of the teacher as living-education agents and mentors within a classical framework; define “living curriculum” language in staff descriptions and professional development that aligns with classical formation.
- For continued growth of Element 2 (Purpose/Goal) and Element 6 (Parents & Community):
 - Maintain and expand parental formation opportunities (book studies, seminars on classical education) and provide more explicit doctrinal and philosophical framing of the school's classical aims to deepen parent understanding of the classical project.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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